

3-10-2021 - CURRICULUM SUBCOMMITTEE NOTES

Chair- Paulette Van der Kloot, called meeting to order at 4:-02 PM Member Graham took attendance: Roll Call: Members Graham, Mustone and Van der Kloot

Purpose: To discuss the ELA curriculum

Invited: Dr. Nicole Chiesa -Director, ELA, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

[Link to Dr. Chiesa's powerpoint presentation*](#)

Dr. Chiesa - MA English LA - 2017 - Mass Literacy Guidelines, 2020-2021 & Early Literacy Screener Guidelines, and Literacy Grants - ELA Frameworks - Reading, Writing, Listening, Language and Speaking Standards - K-5

Mass Literacy - science of reading and provides educators with evidence based resources for early literacy instruction

District Professional Development included: The Hill for Literacy, Crafting Minds, Dr. Nadine Gaab, NWEA Map Growth Training & Data Dives, Lexia Rapid Training & Data Dives, Lexia Core-5 Training, Lexia Power Up, NewsELA, Creating an Inclusive Classroom and DESE Mass Literacy Resources

At Brooks, McGlynn & Roberts - Lexia Rapid and at Columbus - NWEA Map Growth

Early Literacy Screener - develop screening procedures for dyslexia (2008) - still awaiting final guidelines

Member Graham - has the District made a comment on the guidelines?

Dr. Chiesa - Medford is not a specific stakeholder so I haven't seen the draft yet - we have a sense about it, but no draft yet. Moving on - In response to the State expectations, the District has worked hard to make partnerships and Professional Development, evidence based reading, science of reading - creating inclusive classrooms - idea of PD done this year and last school year as well - The Hill for Literacy - enhanced core reading for K-2 and did PD for us - Crafting Minds - presented to our staff, science of reading, when students hit stumbling blocks --- how can we teach them to push through? -Lexia Learning - inclusive classrooms making sure all voices are heard - Lexia Power Up

Components of ELA for K-5 - Reading for informational text, writing, reading for literature, Language, Speaking & Listening and Reading for foundational skills

ELA Tier1 - Elementary Curriculum resources - Enhanced Core Reading Instruction (ECRI) Journeys, NWEA Map Intervention, Lexia Learning, NewsELA (students can access reading at different levels) Moby Read digital Library, Reading A to Z (for K-2 & for students in need of reading support past grade 2)

Lexia Learning is constantly growing and we are growing with it - we are pleased with Lexia rapid and core 5

Other Resources: Readworks, Zaner-Bloser for writing, Classroom novels, audio books, additional informational texts with multicultural emphasis & additional excerpts

Elementary, Tier 2 - Houghton Mifflin Harcourt Decoding Power, Lexia Core 5 and Reading A to Z with assists with intervention & enrichment, ECRI, Write-in Readers, Tier 2, and Houghton Mifflin Harcourt Toolkits, Tier 2 - Done during reading blocks and WIN Blocks

Elementary Assessments/Accountability - Early Literacy Screeners that include progress monitoring, Beginning of Year Assessments, WIN Assessments, Running Records, Unit Assessments, ELA Mock MCAS Assessments for grades 3-5 & ELA MCAS for grades 3-6

Member Graham - Didn't principals ask for Zaner Block- and it wasn't funded?

Dr. Chiesa - they tried to expand to other grade levels, as well as other consumables, but it wasn't able to be provided...am I correct?

Ms. Galusi - it was something the principals were working with Jan Hollenbeck (OT) and yes you are correct on printing and cursive writing - it was put on hold due to covid for K-4 - future conversation on this to continue to work on this

Ms. Hayes - what is ECRI? What materials would I look for?

Dr. Chiesa - targeting phonics, how the teacher presents it - they are taking foundational piece of Journeys in pieces, in whole group instruction - without covid - they'd be going over sounds - the teachers were trained in October - during a WIN block or Tier 2 reading for a little more direct instruction

Ms. Hayes - the sequence of Journeys - the sequence that phonics is taught - my 3rd grader isn't being taught those - what is the plan - Orton Gillingham course for teachers? It doesn't match

with the Journeys piece at all - doesn't look cohesive to me - and I haven't seen it brought back into the classroom - lack of word attack skills

Dr. Chiesa - Journeys doesn't follow OG, Overarching pieces - students engage in those pieces - ECRI - isn't just Journeys - explicit instruction - as we adjust

Ms. Hayes - the problem is Journeys doesn't begin to touch on syllables until 3rd grade

Dr. Chiesa - ECRI is going to push some of those forward in lower grades

Ms. Hayes - If Journeys doesn't touch these pieces, they'll need other

Dr. Chiesa - Decodable readers and ECRI

Ms. Royane - Journeys are not evidence based, ERCI is not going to fix it - are we going to see evidence based?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would like Dr. Chiesa to present secondary please

Dr. Chiesa: ELA Secondary Curriculum & Resources - 6-12

Reading for Informational Text, Writing, Reading for Literature, Language and Speaking and Listening

Secondary, Tier 1

Social Commentary • Literary Analysis • Literary Heritage • Cultural Perspectives • Art of Voice • Language of Literature • Literary Movement

Each unit is highly comprehensive and includes each of the ELA anchor standards (reading for informational, reading for fictional, language, writing, speaking and listening • Writing Genres: Each unit includes several genres of writing, with a specific focus on one particular writing per unit. • Reading Genres: Each unit includes informational text, fictional stories and/or novels, and additional excerpts. A specific focus on infusing diverse voices has been a primary goal of the department. • Each educator operates with a specific pacing guide that includes these units in specific writing sequence.

Secondary Tier 2 - Middle School: WIN Bloc, Double Block, and Lexia Power-Up (for 6th & 7th grade students) and High School: Literacy Challenge Class for our EL and our MCAS Challenges classes (mini's that meet 2 times per week)

Secondary Tier 1 - Assessment/Accountability

Beginning of Year Assessments • Lexia Power-Up Assessments • Unit Assessments - tests, projects, writing assignments. • ELA Mock MCAS Assessments, 6-8, 10 • ELA MCAS 6-8, 10 • Advanced Placement Exams - Grades 11 & 12

Equity in ELA

Adding in numerous novels and diverse authors

Creating inclusive classrooms

Inclusion in Pacing Guides

Addition of NewsELA

Identity Wheel

Exploring Identity and Culture

Mirrors and Windows Collection

A Mile in our Shoes Collection

Exploration Slides

Black Students Matter Collection

Goals & Next Steps: Elementary: Science of reading evidence based Instruction, Early Literacy Screener, Intervention, New Resources to support ELA Instruction & Equity and Inclusivity for K-5

Educate staff on Mass Literacy Guidelines • Continue literacy partnerships • Continue and increase professional development on evidence-based instruction • Review early literacy guidelines once available, and recommend early literacy screener

Cultivate additional programs to support the science of reading including, but not limited to: • Enhanced Core Reading Instruction • Lexia Learning • NewsELA • Continue adding additional supports as needed • Continue incorporating equity into reading • Continue work on literacy plan integrating Mass Literacy Guidelines

This slide (photo) responds to Ms. Royane question a bit - need to enhance the yellow cubes below - Teachers will need more PD since some of this rolled out during covid
Arrows are the process, keeping in mind utilizing the resources below (yellow cubes)

Member Van der Kloot - could you be clear, at which point would you be recommending a new reading program?

Dr. Chiesa - our pilot was pushed out a bit with covid - so probably 2023 school year

Member Van der Kloot - would every school have a pilot?

Dr. Chiesa - yes, we offer it to all elementary schools

Member Van der Kloot - the goal would be for K-5?

Dr. Chiesa - yes

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - in terms of time table - parallel time table - at Elementary level the math screening team is reconvening in late Spring, so the top 2 that were being screened, will be piloted in Sept of 21 - throughout the district, teachers will need that PD - and then we will make a recommendation to SC in March of 22 - to pick one based on what was piloted - so this process would then follow the following year - so they'd restart with the next content area

Dr. Chiesa - Secondary - Equity/Inclusivity, Digital Resources, Accessibility Intervention, (huge one in grades 6-12, we have tried to be very creative for our Tiered 2 students supported with Cares Act funding) consistency - important for our teachers, so EL and SPED teachers can follow at their own pace - very important to be on same unit at same time especially with covid - we offer different types of texts too

Secondary Next Steps/Goals - Educate staff on Mass Literacy Guidelines • Continue literacy partnerships • Continue and increase professional development on

evidence-based instruction • Cultivate additional programs to support all students in ELA • Lexia Learning • NewsELA • Continue adding additional supports as needed • Continue incorporating equity into reading • Continue work on literacy plan integrating Mass Literacy Guidelines

Price Points - thanks to School Committee and Cares Act - I appreciate the support and the questions too - an example of price points slide - they don't all come from ELA budget - literacy screener will in 2021-2022 budget - I'm going to ask for the Lexia Power up for grades 6-8 and our PD for literacy is an investment

Member Van der Kloot - Lexia Core 5 - \$39,000 - is that a recurring cost?

Dr. Chiesa - Yes - this year it was CARES act, year before was free - it was K-2 but expanded but we were able to utilize CARES money

Member Van der Kloot - it's needed, but a substantial ask

Dr. Chiesa - yes

Ms. Galusi - ERCI - so people are clear - Hill Literacy provide materials to teachers, Journeys - teachers have what they need to make sure program is utilized - materials are there to provide skills to students

Member Graham - Secondary level - not having enough resources to do what we would have needed to do at middle school level and I would like to encourage you to be clear what you need from this school committee and the City in this upcoming budget - if you need 3 teachers, ask for it - if you need resources - we need you to tell us what you need - we don't want generations of our students struggling to - outline what is needed - I'm not afraid to tell the city we need more money - so we can advocate for the students

Dr. Chiesa - I appreciate that

Member Graham - I understand the process to roll out curriculums in the same year is difficult - however, is there any way the process could be accelerated? For example, maybe math knows curriculum they want for example, so might not need a pilot - if we need to negotiate for more PD we need to know - if there is a way to speed up this process, an out of the box thought - especially on elementary level - as literacy is so important and I am concerned about the kids we might leave behind

Dr. Chiesa - I'm not sure. However I do feel that the literacy middle school specialists are important - Tiered 2 - I know they fought really hard to keep them, but couldn't

Member Graham - I think I heard there was good news coming from Washington today

Suzi Weiss - ECRI - I was a literacy interventionist - I taught it - teachers do get everything they need - they have built these materials to work with different publishers - it's an add on - it's a really great program - the skills are taught with ECRI and other programs

Member Van der Kloot - anyone want to add anything?

Ms. Hayes - Systematic explicit phonics - what are we looking at - like a Journeys or explicit phonics - or from Hill and Crafting for suggestions

Dr. Chiesa - the committee will be very important - working with Hill and hopeful to pull them in to work with committee - they are experts and leaders in the field and DESE as well - we have to build these partnerships - K-5 holistic approach

Member Van der Kloot - Meeting with the Mayor and group of parents with dyslexia - could you just clarify their concerns? Will our new pick be comprehensive for dyslexia?

Dr. Chiesa - Yes, sure. Medford's program won't have a Wilson component - but our special education and EL are a big part of how we decide on a program - a solid intervention program, a solid Tier 1

Member Graham - doing a focused job on tier 1, foundational level - we did put on the list of standing reports - when assessments are given, aggregated results were requested to be forwarded to the school committee

Dr. Chiesa - we will look at the best way to report it to you

Member Graham - if we fixed our tier 1 tomorrow it still wouldn't solve all of our student's issues - for children who need more intervention now - what do we need to be planning for as we think about tier 2 and 3? What do we need to be thinking about now to try to address learning loss during pandemic? Future changes won't impact them

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - we know that teaching under these conditions- SEL concerns and gaps - we are already thinking about the gaps that will be present - we are in the beginning stages of how that will look - it's on our radar - we are very aware of it and we know we aren't alone - we will come up with a plan

Member Van der Kloot - Motion to adjourn by Member Graham, seconded by member Mustone

Roll Call 3-0 to adjourn at 5:21 PM